Management of a communicable disease outbreak



- Preparation
- Detection
- Response
- Evaluation

Preparation for the outbreak

- Health coordination meetings
- Strong surveillance system
- Outbreak response plan for each disease
- Stocks of IV fluids, antibiotics and vaccines
- Plans for isolation wards
- Laboratory support

Detection of outbreak

- Surveillance system with early warning system for epidemic prone diseases.
- Inform ministry of health and WHO in case of outbreaks of specific diseases.
- Take appropriate specimens (stool, CSF or serum) for laboratory confirmation.
- Include cases in the weekly reports
- Assess appropriateness and effectiveness of containment measures.
- Assess timelines of outbreak detection and response.
- Change public health policy if indicated.
- Write and disseminate outbreak report
- Global Disease Eradication Efforts

Methods to accomplish the goal of eradication of diseases include:

- immunization and vaccination
- drug therapy
- community training
- health education
- national disease surveillance efforts

Nurses' Role

Community health nurses play an important role with regard to all population at risk for communicable disease

Nurses concerned with communicable disease control must

- Recognize vulnerable area.
- Locate the reservoirs and source of infectious disease agents
- Identify the environmental factors which promote the spread of communicable disease.
- Identify characteristic of vulnerability of community member and groups- particularly those subject to intervention
- Community health nurses must work collaboratively with other public health professional. Organize immunization and educational programs, to improve community infection control policies.

SUMMARY

1. The important water borne diseases are typhoid fever, cholera, hepatitis A and acute diarrhoeal disease. Typhoid fever is caused by salmonella typhi and the mode of transmission is by faeco oral route. Complication of typhoid fever is intestinal perforation.
2. **Cholera** is an acute infectious disease caused by cholera (vibrio cholera) and the mode of transmission is by oro -faecal route.
3. Cholera is a notifiable disease and it not identified and treated early can cause sudden death.
4. **Hepatitis** - is a systematic disorder that primarily affects the liver. The causative organism is hepatitis a virus. Mode of transmission is faeco oral route and direct contact and the incubation period is 15 to 50 days usually 28 days.

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